Dual App Platform for On-Demand Daily Wage Worker Services

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Introduction

- Over 450 million individuals are employed in India's informal labor market, and a sizable fraction of them are skilled people who work in maintenance, building, and home repair. The process by which a family finds a reliable, available plumber or electrician has not significantly changed in decades, despite this large workforce. The dominant model remains word-of-mouth referral or physical search which are inherently slow , geographically constrained, and opaque.

- Meanwhile, There are more than 700 million smartphone users in India and regional language apps make smartphones accessible to people who don't speak English. Although a digital labor marketplace's infrastructure is in place, its design has not been sufficiently adapted to the real user base.

- Crewli positions itself at this intersection. It's not a platform for general gigs. It is a context-specific, trust-first, speed-optimized platform built around the realities of how unpaid skilled people work and how customers think when they have a power outage or a broken pipe at eight o'clock on a Saturday.

Problem Statement

The challenge is not a shortage of skilled workers

it is a structural mismatch between supply and demand that neither party has efficient tools to resolve. The following breakdown identifies specific pain points on each side:

1 Customer-Side Friction

- **No centralized discovery:**

Finding an electrician requires calling neighbors, checking physical boards, or relying on saved contacts , all of which fail in new localities or urgent situations.

- **Trust uncertainty:**

Without credentials, ratings, or verifiable history, every new service engagement carries implicit risk of incomplete work, overcharging.

- **Category confusion:**

Many users cannot accurately name the service they need (e.g., 'water motor issue' vs. 'plumbing' vs. 'electrician'), causing failed searches on existing platforms.

- **No real-time availability:**

Even when a worker is found, confirming their availability requires multiple calls and often ends in rescheduling.

2 Worker-Side Friction

- **Income unpredictability:**

Daily wage workers face irregular work schedules with no forward visibility into upcoming demand, making income planning difficult.

- **Limited reach:**

Workers depend on repeat customers and local reputation; they have no mechanism to reach new customers beyond their immediate area.

- **No digital presence:**

Most skilled workers do not have the literacy or resources to build any form of online profile or portfolio.

- **Payment delays:**

Cash-based transactions with unknown customers often result in delayed or disputed payments.

3 Market Gap

Existing platforms like Urban Company cater primarily to premium urban users with high service costs and standardized packages. The vast middle market : households in Tier 2 and Tier 3 cities, students, renters, small shop owners remains underserved. This demographic needs affordable, fast, and trust-adequate service connections, not premium service bundles.

Proposed Solution

Crewli is structured as two separate mobile applications sharing a unified backend - a Customer App and a Worker App

each optimized for its respective user's context, literacy level, and objective.

1 Customer App

The Customer App is designed to simplify service discovery and reduce decision friction, especially in urgent scenarios.

- **Structured Problem Selection:**

Instead of requiring users to search manually, the app provides predefined service categories (e.g., Electrical, Plumbing, Cleaning). Users first select a category and are then guided to choose the exact problem they are facing (e.g., “fan not working”, “pipe leakage”).

- **AI Assistance**

To reduce decision friction and improve booking accuracy, Crewli integrates an AI-powered assistant within the Customer App. The AI determines when the user is ready to book and signals the system to display a “Book Now” option, ensuring that suggestions are contextual rather than forced.

- **Instant Worker Booking:**

Once the problem is selected, the system automatically matches and assigns a nearby available worker, eliminating the need for multiple calls or negotiations.

- **Expanded Use Cases (After Work Cleaning Services):**

In addition to services, users can also directly book after work cleaning services, increasing platform utility and frequency of use.

- **Direct Communication:**

After booking, the customer can connect with the worker through in-app calling or messaging, ensuring clarity on location, timing, and requirements.

2 Worker App

The Worker App is designed for speed, visibility, and ease of response, considering the working conditions of daily wage workers.

- **Call-like Job Notifications:**

Incoming work requests are delivered as high-priority, call-style notifications, ensuring workers do not miss opportunities due to passive alerts.

- **One-Tap Accept/Reject System:**

Workers can quickly respond to job requests, minimizing delay and improving real-time availability matching.

- **Direct Customer Connection:**

Once a job is accepted, workers can directly communicate with the customer, similar to ride-hailing platforms, enabling coordination without intermediaries.

- **Continuous Job Flow:**

By digitizing demand, workers gain access to a broader customer base beyond their immediate locality, improving income consistency.